NewsBank inc.

New laws in the U.S.: wage increases, rights for undocumented immigrants and tax on gun purchases

July 1, 2024 | CE Noticias Financieras: English
Section: News | 624 Words
OpenURL Link

Beginning July 1, 2024, U.S. residents will experience significant legislative changes. These new laws are intended to improve workers' rights and support undocumented immigrants, reflecting evolving social and economic priorities.

In Washington In Washington State, one of the laws that will go into effect will directly benefit undocumented individuals, as they will be able to apply for professional licenses, something that previously required the presentation of a social security number.

These permits are granted for commercial work and occupations that require extensive training or involve risks to consumers, ranging from architects, educators and accountants to tour guides.

However, an essential requirement will remain the possession of a valid tax identification number in order to obtain such a license.

Additionally, effective July 1, the minimum wage in Washington increased from $17 to $17.50 an hour, while for tipped workers, the wage was raised from $8 to $10 an hour.

California On the other hand, in California the purchase and sale of firearms, ammunition and components used in their manufacture will be subject to an 11% excise tax.

The revenues generated by AB 28 will fund gun violence prevention and gang intervention programs in California. The federal government already levies such a tax nationwide, but California will be the first state to implement it.

The legislation introduced by Assemblyman Jesse Gabriel (D-Encino) will cover sales to active duty and retired police and law enforcement officers, as well as sales by family-owned retailers with reported revenues of less than $5,000 per quarter.

State budget analyses predict that this tax will raise $159 million in its first year. According to experts, if retailers pass the tax on to the end consumer, it could generate additional sales and up to $14 million in tax revenue for state and local governments.

Finding hidden fees SB 478 aims to simplify disclosure of hidden fees that could come as a surprise to consumers when taking trips, ordering food delivery, purchasing tickets to music events, and more.

Businesses in the service and travel industry must incorporate charges in the prices they advertise. AB 537 requires hotels and short-term rental companies to disclose the total cost before the visitor concludes his or her stay.

Although mandates initially applied to restaurants and bars, Governor Newsom ratified emergency legislation over the weekend, exempting merchants from this new regulation. Surcharges must still be clearly specified for clientele.

In Illinois In Illinois, a benefit was announced for undocumented immigrants, allowing them to obtain a driver's license that will serve as an acceptable form of identification.

Beginning July 1, non-citizen residents of the United States will be able to apply for this license without the need to

present a social security number.

A significant modification lies in the fact that, instead of being marked as invalid for federal identification purposes, the license will now include a legend indicating "federal limitations apply," so that, for example, it cannot be used to board a domestic flight or enter restricted government buildings.

In the same state, service sector employees who receive tips and earn below minimum wage will experience an increase in their income.

They currently receive $9.40 and will benefit from an 8% annual increase over the next 5 years, until they reach the Chicago minimum wage of $15.80.

An estimated 100,000 tipped workers in Chicago will be affected by this measure.

As reported by the Chicago Tribune, this legislation makes Chicago the largest city in the United States to eliminate tipped wages for service sector workers.

Tennessee Through a new law in Tennessee, students will be able to feel safer, as the state of Tennessee decided to pass a law that allows students to carry Tasers, Taser or other means of self-defense to respond quickly to any possible attack on college campuses.

Copyright © 2024 ContentEngine, LLC, All rights reserved.

- **Citation (apa Style)**
  New laws in the U.S.: wage increases, rights for undocumented immigrants and tax on gun purchases. (2024, July 1)*ÇE Noticias Financieras: English*. Available from NewsBank: Access World News – Historical and Current: https://infoweb.newsbank.com/apps/news/document-view?p=WORLDNEWS&docref=news/19A6E136DCEF49A0.